Interactive page

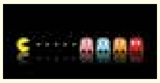
THE PSYCHOLOGY OF CHANGE

It's said that 'change is good for innovation & survival' and it's probably also one of the reasons brands choose to revamp regularly. This change however, has major effects on the psychology of its users every time these companies bring in a change.
http://dgit.in/PsyOfChg

AI IS THE WAY TO GO

Facebook has been adding newer features and adopting newer algorithms like never before, it not only wants to focus on embracing AI but also excel in machine learning, in order to build the world's most powerful ad platform, leaving its competitors behind.
http://dgit.in/FaceBkAI

PAC MAN SCORE – 3,330,360

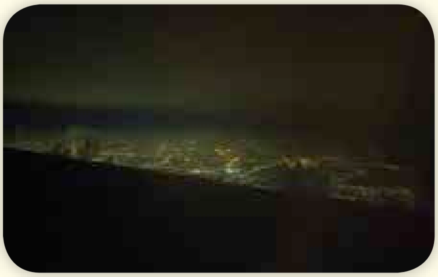


Navigating through 256 levels and eating every pellet, fruit, and ghost, that too without dying, Billy Mitchell, the 'Pac Man' achieved this verified perfect score on a arcade machine with a playtime of around five and a half hours.
http://dgit.in/PacManHS

TILL THE LAST MILE

This one isn't about the wonders of TCP/IP or the working of the internet but about the technology that goes into how stuff works, such as things with bigger infrastructure like submarine cables, landing sites, and data centres, which play a pivotal role in hooking billions of us to the Internet.
http://dgit.in/IntDataC

Unfortunately, the Hybrid Focussing mechanism, coupled with its image processor and Sony's algorithm, was far from being the fastest camera module around. Hence, the rise of Predictive Hybrid Autofocus. What the technology essentially does is provide a better, artificially intelligent camera algorithm, a faster image processor and better integration of the camera hardware and software. Sony has essentially used an Exmor RS mobile imaging sensor here, improving its algorithm and processing capabilities. Sony now claims that in 0.6 seconds, you can go from idle to photograph captured. Predictive Hybrid Autofocus comes into play as soon as the camera module is switched on. It reads the frame, adjusts to the possible subject by phase detection autofocus, and locks on to it. This is particularly beneficial for moving objects, as you have very little time to adjust focus or select the subject in such situations. Its predictive algorithms read the screen and assist fully in choosing the subject. This, till the time your photograph is saved, is expected to take 0.6 seconds.



Sony Xperia X (L), Huawei Nexus 6P (R)

HOW WELL DOES IT WORK?

In real life, the implementation is a tad different from what it sounds like on paper. While the camera does set up its focus point almost instantaneously, manual reset of the focus (which you may often need) takes a longer amount of time than what you would expect. The predictive technology is particularly useful if you are shooting moving objects, and the camera often struggles if the subject of the photograph is moving too fast. In regular situations (shooting landscapes or portraits, for instance), there is little to no visible upgrade in the camera's speed of shooting. The company is attempting to bring the technology to its smartphones from the Sony A6000 lineup of mirrorless cameras, and while it is much better implemented and has more practical applications in a dedicated camera like the A6000, its effect of promoting the Xperia X to greater heights is marginal.

In ideal situations, with bright lights and little to no background activity taking up processing power, the technology works better and you get to take better shots with more precise focussing and marginal subject blurring. As you progress to dusk or low light situations, PHAF struggles to maintain its performance. It may work better on the Xperia X Performance with Qualcomm's Spectra ISP working faster in tandem with the Snapdragon 820, but we are yet to test that.

Sony Xperia X (L), Huawei Nexus 6P (R)

THE POTENTIAL AND FUTURE OF PHAF

To sum up, while the technology has potential for majorly improving the experience of shooting photographs at races, wildlife, or even shooting on the move, it has not been very well implemented yet, and almost certainly not well enough to be a very notable. It is, however, an answer to what other OEMs are doing with their smartphones. Samsung brought Dual Pixel to the table, majorly improving focus duration and light and colour data processing. While the Predictive Hybrid Autofocus technology may not be as vividly noticeable an upgrade as what Samsung has done, it is a peg for the future, and once developed to its full potential, has the ability to remove out-of-focus shots and difficulties in autofocus in video shootings from mobile devices.

As of now, the technology is not too noticeable in the Sony Xperia X. As for the future of smartphone photography, it may be an important step to take, taking us ever so closer to dedicated camera phones. d